



# Safety1st

*Personal safety, the moment it matters most.*

**Developed by APEX**

Concept Overview & Product Pitch — Phase 1

## The Problem

South Africa continues to face a high rate of violent crime, including mugging, physical assault, and other personal safety threats that can happen anywhere, anytime. In many of these moments, the difference between a safe outcome and a dangerous one comes down to seconds: how quickly someone can call for help, and how quickly that help can find them.

Alongside this, communities continue to experience gaps in service delivery, leaving people without fast, reliable ways to alert others or summon support when something goes wrong. Existing solutions are often too slow, too complicated to use under pressure, or too expensive for the people who need them most.

**Safety1st was built to close that gap.**

## The Solution: Safety1st

Safety1st is a personal safety alert platform, available as both a website and a mobile app (Android), designed to get help to someone in danger as fast as possible. With a single action, a user in distress can send an alert that is fast, location-aware, and loud enough to draw immediate attention from the people around them.

### Core Features

- **Rapid alerts:** an alert is triggered and sent within approximately 17 seconds, fast enough to matter in an emergency.
- **Automatic timestamping:** every alert is logged with the exact time it was raised, creating a reliable record of when the incident occurred.
- **Near-precise location detection:** the platform captures a close-to-exact location at the moment the alert is triggered, so responders and contacts know where to go.
- **High-volume alarm sound:** triggering an alert sets off a very loud audible alarm on the user's device, designed to draw the attention of bystanders and discourage an attacker, similar in spirit to a personal panic alarm.
- **Synchronized receiver alert:** the same urgent alert sound plays on the receiver's end (trusted contacts, responders, or community members), immediately communicating the severity of the situation rather than a routine notification.
- **Cross-platform availability:** built first as a website, with a companion Android app, so it works whether a person has a smartphone app installed or only browser access.

## How It Works

Safety1st is built around a simple principle: in an emergency, the user should not need to think, type, or navigate. One trigger should be enough to set the entire response chain in motion.

| Step | What Happens                                                                                   |
|------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1    | The user triggers an alert from the app or website, even under pressure, with a single action. |

| Step | What Happens                                                                                                                                    |
|------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2    | Safety1st instantly timestamps the alert and pulls a close-to-exact location reading from the device.                                           |
| 3    | A loud alarm sound is triggered on the user's device, drawing the attention of people nearby and signalling that something is wrong.            |
| 4    | The alert, along with the timestamp and location, is sent to designated contacts or responders.                                                 |
| 5    | The receiver's device plays the same urgent alert sound, instantly communicating that this is a high-priority emergency, not a routine message. |

## Why It Matters

Every feature in Safety1st is built around one outcome: getting real help to a real person, fast, when it matters most.

- Speed saves lives: a 17-second alert time means help is on the way before a situation has the chance to escalate further.
- Bystander intervention: a loud, attention-grabbing alarm can interrupt an assault or mugging in progress by drawing public attention to the scene, something a silent notification can never do.
- Shared urgency: because receivers hear the same alarm sound, there is no ambiguity about how serious the alert is. People can respond immediately rather than wondering if it can wait.
- Accurate response: timestamp and location data mean responders, family, or community safety groups know exactly when and where the incident happened, reducing wasted time searching.

## The Team

Safety1st is developed by APEX, a team focused on building practical technology that responds directly to the safety and service delivery challenges faced by communities in South Africa.

## Phase 1: Where We Are Today

What's outlined in this document is Phase 1 of Safety1st: a focused, working core built around the fundamentals that matter most in an emergency, fast alerts, accurate location, urgent sound, and a reliable record of when an incident occurred. The priority for this phase was proving that the core alert system works, and works fast, before building outward.

**This is intentionally a starting point, not the finished product.**

## Looking Ahead

Given the opportunity to take Safety1st further, APEX has a strong pipeline of features still to come, including:

- Community-based responder networks, connecting users to nearby verified responders or neighbourhood safety groups, not just personal contacts.

- Integration with local safety initiatives and, where possible, official emergency services.
- Deeper incident reporting tools to help track and address service delivery gaps alongside personal safety.
- Offline and low-connectivity support, so alerts can still be sent in areas with poor network coverage.
- A trusted contacts and community trust-rating system, to help verify responders and reduce misuse.
- Historical alert and safety analytics, to help identify high-risk areas and times.

*Phase 1 proves the concept. The roadmap beyond it is where Safety1st grows into a full safety ecosystem.*

***Safety first. Every time.***